

TOOL

1. Passage anchor

> “...even a small business needs the right **tools**, materials, and a bit of breathing room at the beginning.”

Passage meaning

tool = an object or piece of equipment used to carry out a task

工具；**器具**

Here, the speaker means practical baking/business equipment such as mixers, trays, scales, piping tools, etc.

Practice

1. Good baking **tools** make the work easier.
好的烘焙**工具**會令工作更容易。
2. I would need to buy the right **tools** before starting the business.
開始這門生意前，我需要買合適的**工具**。

Core meanings of TOOL

2. tool — physical implement

= object, usually held or operated by hand, used to perform a particular task

工具；**器具**

Examples

1. A knife is an important kitchen **tool**.
刀是一種重要的廚房**工具**。
2. Keep the **tools** in a safe place.
把**工具**放在安全地方。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. hand tool

= tool powered mainly by the user's hands rather than a motor

****手工具****

Examples

1. The workshop contains basic ****hand tools****.

工場裡有基本的****手工具****。

2. A screwdriver is a common ****hand tool****.

螺絲批是一種常見的****手工具****。

Equipment / instrument

4. tool — specialized equipment

= object or device used for a specific professional or practical purpose

****器械；工具；設備****

Examples

1. The camera is an important ****tool**** for the photographer.

相機是攝影師的重要****工具****。

2. A thermometer is a useful ****tool**** in the kitchen.

溫度計是廚房裡很實用的****工具****。

Figurative: means to achieve a goal

5. tool — method or resource

= something used to achieve a particular purpose

****手段；方法；工具****

Examples

1. Language is a powerful ****tool**** for communication.

語言是溝通的重要****工具****。

2. Education can be a ****tool**** for social change.

教育可以成為推動社會改變的****手段****。

Major figurative sense.

6. tool for something

= means used to accomplish a result

****用來.....的工具 / 手段****

Examples

1. Feedback is a useful ****tool for improvement****.
回饋是促進改善的有用****工具****。
2. Data can be a powerful ****tool for decision-making****.
數據可以成為決策的重要****工具****。

Software / digital

7. tool — software utility

= program, feature, or application designed to help perform a specific task

****軟體工具；數位工具****

Examples

1. We use an online ****tool**** to manage orders.
我們使用線上****工具****管理訂單。
2. This design ****tool**** is easy to use.
這個設計****工具****很容易使用。

Very high-value modern sense.

8. digital tool

= software or online resource used to perform a task

****數位工具****

Examples

1. Small businesses rely on many ****digital tools****.
小企業依賴很多****數位工具****。

2. The app is a useful **digital tool** for scheduling.

這個應用程式是排程的實用**數位工具**。

9. developer tool

= software used to build, debug, test, or manage software

開發工具

Examples

1. The browser includes several **developer tools**.

瀏覽器包含幾個**開發工具**。

2. The team uses automated testing **tools**.

團隊使用自動化測試**工具**。

Tool of another person / organization

10. tool — person used by someone else

Figurative, usually negative:

= person controlled or used by another person, group, or organization

被利用的人；工具人；傀儡

Examples

1. He was accused of being a **tool** of the organization.

他被指是該組織的**工具 / 傀儡**。

2. She refused to become anyone's **tool**.

她拒絕成為任何人的**利用工具**。

Distinct figurative sense.

Informal insult

11. tool — foolish / unpleasant person

Informal, especially AmE:

= person considered stupid, obnoxious, or easily manipulated

****笨蛋；討厭鬼****

Examples

1. Don't be such a ****tool****.

別這麼****蠢 / 討人厭****。

2. He acted like a complete ****tool****.

他表現得像個十足的****笨蛋****。

Register-sensitive and insulting.

Manufacturing / machining

12. tool — cutting/forming device in machinery

= implement used by a machine to cut, shape, drill, or form material

****刀具；加工工具****

Examples

1. The machine uses a diamond cutting ****tool****.

這部機器使用鑽石切削****刀具****。

2. The ****tool**** must be replaced when worn.

****刀具****磨損後必須更換。

13. machine tool

= power-driven machine used to cut or shape metal or other materials

****機床****

Examples

1. The factory produces precision ****machine tools****.

工廠生產精密****機床****。

2. A lathe is a type of ****machine tool****.

車床是一種****機床****。

Verb: shape/work with tools

14. tool — work or shape with a tool

= make, shape, decorate, or process something using tools

用工具加工；雕飾

Examples

1. The leather was carefully **tooled** by hand.

皮革被手工仔細**壓花加工**。

2. The metal was **tooled** into shape.

金屬被**加工成形**。

This verb is more specialized.

15. tooled leather

= leather decorated by pressing/cutting patterns into it

壓花皮革；雕飾皮革

Examples

1. The bag is made from **tooled leather**.

這個袋由**壓花皮革**製成。

2. The cover has a **tooled** pattern.

封面有**壓印花紋**。

Tooling

16. tooling

A. machinery/tools used in manufacturing

工裝；模具；刀具設備

1. The factory invested in new **tooling**.

工廠投資了新的**工裝設備**。

B. process of creating tools/molds for production

****工裝製作；模具製作****

2. ****Tooling**** costs can be high.

****模具 / 工裝成本****可能很高。

Toolkit / toolset

17. toolkit

A. physical set of tools

****工具箱；工具組****

1. He keeps a small ****toolkit**** in the car.

他在車裡放了一個小****工具箱****。

B. figurative collection of methods/resources

****方法工具包；一套實用資源****

2. The course gives teachers a practical ****toolkit****.

這門課提供教師一套實用的****方法工具包****。

18. toolset

= collection of tools or capabilities available for a task

****工具組；工具集****

Examples

1. The software provides a useful ****toolset****.

這套軟體提供實用的****工具集****。

2. Communication skills are part of a manager's ****toolset****.

溝通技巧是管理者****能力工具組****的一部分。

Toolbox

19. toolbox

A. box used to store tools

****工具箱****

1. Put the hammer back in the ****toolbox****.
把鎚子放回****工具箱****。

B. figurative collection of skills or methods

****技能 / 方法庫****

2. Negotiation is one tool in her professional ****toolbox****.
談判是她專業****技能庫****中的一項工具。

You already have ****toolbox**** mapped separately, so this is included only as a family relation.

High-value expressions

20. the right tool for the job

= the most suitable instrument, method, or person for a particular task
****最適合某項工作的工具 / 方法****

Examples

1. Make sure you use the ****right tool for the job****.
確保你使用****最適合這項工作的工具****。
2. A spreadsheet may be the ****right tool for the job****.
試算表可能是這項工作的****合適工具****。

Literal or figurative.

21. tool of the trade / tools of the trade

= equipment, skills, or methods normally needed in a profession
****行業必備工具；吃飯工具****

Examples

1. Knives are among a chef's **tools of the trade**.
刀是廚師的**行業必備工具**之一。
2. Good communication is one of a manager's **tools of the trade**.
良好溝通是管理者的**必備技能之一**。

22. tool up

= equip a factory, company, or person with tools/equipment needed for production
配備工具；準備生產設備

Examples

1. The factory **tooled up** for increased production.
工廠**添置設備**準備增加生產。
2. The company had to **tool up** quickly.
公司必須迅速**配備生產設備**。

Established but more industrial.

Key contrasts

23. tool vs equipment

tool

= individual implement or specific means used for a task

工具

equipment

= collective set of tools, machines, or items needed for an activity

設備；器材

Compare:

- > a whisk is a tool
> 打蛋器是一件工具
- > baking equipment
> 烘焙設備

****Equipment**** is normally uncountable.

24. tool vs instrument

****instrument****

= often precise or specialized device used for measurement, science, medicine, or music

****儀器；器械；樂器****

****tool****

= broader practical implement used to accomplish a task

****工具****

Compare:

> surgical instrument

> 外科器械

> hand tool

> 手工具

25. tool vs machine

****machine****

= powered device with moving parts that performs work

****機器****

****tool****

= may be simple/manual, digital, or figurative; much broader

A machine can itself be a tool.

26. tool vs method

****method****

= procedure or way of doing something

****方法****

****tool****

= resource used within a method to achieve a goal

****工具 / 手段****

Compare:

> teaching method

> 教學方法

> assessment tool

> 評估工具

27. tool vs resource

****resource****

= anything useful that can support a task or goal

****資源****

****tool****

= something more directly applied to perform or accomplish the task

****工具****

Meaning map

The central concept of ****tool**** is:

****something used to perform a task or achieve a result****

From this develop:

Passage

baking tools

→ ****烘焙工具****

Physical

hand tool

→ ****手工工具****

Professional

camera as a tool

→ ****專業工具****

Figurative

education as a tool

→ **實現目標的手段**

Digital

software tool

→ **軟體工具**

Negative person sense

tool of an organization

→ **被利用的工具 / 傀儡**

Informal insult

a tool

→ **笨蛋 / 討厭鬼**

Manufacturing

cutting tool

→ **刀具**

Collection

toolkit / toolset

→ **工具組 / 方法庫**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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tool — physical implement	用來完成特定實際工作的工具 / 器具
hand tool	主要靠人手操作而非馬達驅動的工具
tool — specialized equipment	專業工作中用來完成特定任務的器械 / 設備
tool — figurative means	用來達成某個目的的方法、手段或資源
tool for something	用來完成某目的的工具 / 手段
tool — software	用來執行特定工作或功能的軟體 / 數位工具
digital tool	用來完成工作或解決問題的數位軟體工具
developer tool	用於程式開發、除錯、測試等的開發工具
tool — person used by others	被另一人 / 組織操控、利用的人；工具 / 傀儡

tool — informal insult	非正式貶義：愚蠢、討厭或易受操控的人	
tool — machining	機械加工中用來切削、鑽孔、成形的刀具 / 工具	
machine tool	用來加工金屬等材料的機床	
tool — verb	用工具把材料加工、雕飾或成形	
tooled leather	經壓花 / 雕飾加工的皮革	
tooling	製造業中的工裝、模具、刀具等設備及其製作	
toolkit — physical	一套存放在一起的工具 / 工具箱	
toolkit — figurative	一套可用來處理問題的技能、方法或資源	
toolset	完成某類工作所具備的一組工具 / 能力	
right tool for the job	最適合某項任務的工具或方法	
tools of the trade	某職業通常必須具備的工具、技能或方法	
tool up	為生產 / 工作添置並配備所需工具設備	

Passage recap

> “...even a small business needs the right **tools**, materials, and a bit of breathing room at the beginning.”

Here:

tools = **practical pieces of equipment needed to carry out the work**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **工具**

* **器具**

* contextually: **烘焙 / 營運所需工具**

Natural contextual translation:

因為即使是小生意，起步時也需要合適的工具、材料，以及一點財務上的緩衝空間。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

tool

= **an object or piece of equipment used to perform a particular task**

工具；器具

The most important modern extension is:

> **physical tool**

> → **實體工具**

but:

> ****software tool****

> → 軟體工具

and figuratively:

> ****education is a tool for change****

> → 教育是推動改變的****手段****

There are also two person-related meanings that must be recognized by context:

> ****a tool of the regime****

> → 被某勢力利用的****傀儡 / 工具****

> ****He's a tool.****

> → 非正式貶義：他是個****笨蛋 / 討厭鬼****

So in the passage, ****tool**** stays completely literal and practical: the equipment needed to produce and run the dessert business.